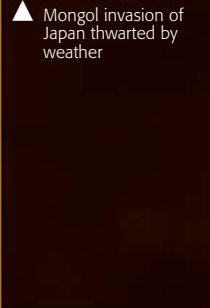
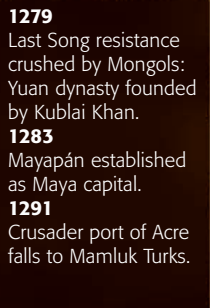


“The title Khan means in our language ‘Great Lord of Lords.’ And certainly he has a right to this title... He is indeed **the greatest lord** the world has ever known.”

MARCO POLO, FROM “THE TRAVELS OF MARCO POLO,” c. 1298

1250	1300	1350	1400
 1261 Byzantines retake Constantinople from Crusaders. 1266 Kublai Khan founds new Mongol capital at Khanbaliq (Beijing); Marco Polo visits Kublai Khan's court. ◀ Benin bronze	 1336 Ashikaga shogunate founded, Japan. 1337 Start of 100 Years War between England and France. 1347 Black Death reaches Europe after ravaging west Asia. ◀ Ottoman helmet	 1375 Catalan Atlas, the first atlas of known trade routes, produced. 1378 Great schism begins between rivals popes in Rome and Avignon. ▲ Alhambra palace	 1436 Portuguese explorer passes Cape Bojador, to begin period of exploration of West African coast. 1438 Inca conquests in South America begin under Pachacuti. Prince Henry of Portugal ▼
 1274 Mongols try to invade Japan; second unsuccessful attempt made in 1281. 1276 First European paper mill at Fabriano, Italy. 1277 Opening of sea route from Italy to Flanders. ▲ Mongol invasion of Japan thwarted by weather	 c. 1300 Osman I founds Ottoman state; first phase of Ottoman expansion. 1302 Last Christian outpost in Holy Lands falls to Mamluk Turks. Black Death ▶	 c. 1350 Conflict between Inca and Chimú states, South America. c. 1354 Ottomans occupy Gallipoli, gaining first foothold in Europe. Ming vase ▶	 1415 England defeats French army at Battle of Agincourt. Portuguese under Prince Henry the Navigator capture Ceuta, first permanent European possession in North Africa. ▼ Catalan Atlas
 c. 1250 Emergence of empire of Benin, Nigeria. 1258 Abbasid caliphate falls as Mongols sack city of Baghdad. 1260 Mamluks defeat Mongols at 'Ayn Jalut. Kublai Khan ▶	 1279 Last Song resistance crushed by Mongols: Yuan dynasty founded by Kublai Khan. 1283 Mayapán established as Maya capital. 1291 Crusader port of Acre falls to Mamluk Turks.	 1360 Treaty of Brétigny ends first phase of 100 Years War. c. 1360 Vijayanagara Empire reaches greatest extent, south India. 1368 Ming dynasty founded, China.	 1389 Battle of Kosovo: Ottomans gain control of Balkans. 1392 Start of Choson dynasty in Korea. 1398 Mongol warrior Timur destroys Delhi, India. ▲ Aztec jade mask
 1428 Expansion of Aztec empire begins, Central America. c. 1430 Bruges emerges as commercial focus of northwest Europe. Bruges, Belgium ▶	 1324 Mansa Musa, emperor of Mali, performs Pilgrimage of Gold to Egypt and Mecca. c. 1325 Aztecs found capital at Tenochtitlán, Mexico. 1333 End of Kamakura shogunate, Japan.	 1389 Battle of Kosovo: Ottomans gain control of Balkans. 1392 Start of Choson dynasty in Korea. 1398 Mongol warrior Timur destroys Delhi, India.	 1428 Expansion of Aztec empire begins, Central America. c. 1430 Bruges emerges as commercial focus of northwest Europe.